

INTERNATIONAL news

Trump to hit foreign chipmakers with 100% tariff

US President Trump plans to impose a 100% tariff on chips from countries without US production, exempting firms that manufacture or plan to manufacture locally. The move boosted tech stocks, such as Apple and Nvidia, easing market fears. It follows the US's continuous push to revive chipmaking, with its global share down to 12% from 40% in 1990.

US launches \$825 million EUV chip R&D facility under CHIPS Act

The US Commerce Department has opened a National Semiconductor Technology Center (NSTC) research facility in Albany,



Representational image

New York, under the CHIPS and Science Act, with up to \$825 million in federal funding. It will advance EUV lithography, support defence R&D, create 600 jobs, and strengthen

domestic semiconductor innovation in partnership with industry and academia.

TSMC reports \$30 billion Q2 revenue, eyes US expansion

TSMC posted a record \$30.1 billion Q2 revenue, up 44.4% YoY, driven by AI and HPC chip demand. It is investing \$165 billion in a six-fab Arizona hub, with 30% of advanced 2nm capacity based there. Despite margin pressures from forex shifts and overseas expansion, TSMC projects nearly 30% full-year 2025 growth and sustained market demand.

Apple pours \$100 billion more into US manufacturing, seals \$500 million rare-earth deal

Apple will invest \$100 billion to expand US manufacturing, creating 20,000 jobs in R&D, AI, and engineering, while avoiding proposed tariffs. This move follows its recent partnership with MP Materials in a \$500 million deal to produce rare earth magnets in Texas and establish a California recycling facility, thereby boosting localisation, sustainability, and skilled job creation.

Texas Instruments posts 16% YoY revenue growth in Q2 2025

Texas Instruments posted \$4.4 billion Q2 revenue, up 16% YoY, with EPS at \$1.41, beating forecasts. Growth was driven by the analogue and embedded segments, as well as surging demand for communications. Operating profit rose 25% to \$1.6 billion. With \$5.4 billion in cash, low debt costs, and substantial shareholder returns, TI forecasts up to \$4.8 billion Q3 revenue despite macroeconomic headwinds.

STMicroelectronics acquires NXP MEMS unit for \$950 million

STMicroelectronics will acquire NXP's MEMS sensors unit for up to \$950 million, boosting its automotive, industrial, and consumer portfolio. The \$300 million revenue business strengthens ST's roadmap in safety-critical automotive sensors and brings R&D expertise. Funded from existing liquidity, the deal is set to close in H1 2026, enhancing ST's global position in the fast-growing MEMS market.

Ambiq Micro plans \$85 million AI chip IPO

Ambiq Micro, a Texas-based manufacturer of ultra-low-power AI chips, plans to raise up to \$85 million through an initial public offering (IPO) on the New York Stock Exchange (NYSE) by selling 3.4 million shares at \$22-\$25 each, valuing the company at approximately \$426 million. Its chips power Samsung Galaxy watches, run five times more efficiently, and target wearables, IoT, and edge AI despite strong competition.

BYD faces 27% tariff, revises Europe manufacturing plans

Chinese auto giant BYD has delayed mass production at its €4 billion Hungarian EV plant to 2026, shifting its focus to Turkey, where output may top 150,000 units by 2027. Rising EU tariffs and costs drive the change. Despite challenges, BYD's European sales are forecast to double by 2025, with Germany being eyed as a possible location for a third factory.

Intel plans restructuring after Q2 loss; Trump demands resignation of CEO

Intel is overhauling operations after a \$2.9 billion Q2 loss, cutting 15% of staff, halting speculative fab projects in Germany and Poland, and tightening investment to match demand. Following this, the political heat surrounding the company intensified after President Trump demanded the resignation of CEO Lip-Bu Tan over alleged ties to China.

US approves Nvidia and AMD chip sales to China with a fee

Shares of Nvidia and AMD surged after the US approved export licenses for Nvidia's H20 and AMD's MI308 AI chips to China, conditioned on the companies paying 15% of their China revenue to Washington. The controversial revenue-sharing deal, brokered after Jensen Huang's meeting with Trump, signals a major shift in US tech trade policy.

Tesla signs \$16.5 billion AI chip deal with Samsung

Tesla has signed a \$16.5 billion deal with Samsung to produce next-gen AI6 chips at its Texas plant for future self-driving cars and humanoid robots. Production may start 2027+, following AI5 chips in 2026. The move boosts Samsung's foundry ambitions beyond memory chips, though the short-term impact on Tesla's current challenges remains limited. Tesla reported a 42% YoY decline in operating income for Q2 2025, falling from \$1.6 billion to \$923 million.

Foxconn sells \$88 million EV facility, retains manufacturing operations

Foxconn has sold its Ohio Lordstown plant to partner Crescent Dune LLC for \$88 million in a sale-leaseback deal, retaining EV production and jobs. Proceeds will fund US projects in EVs and advanced manufacturing, as Foxconn realigns its strategy to expand beyond electronics into high-tech sectors, reinforcing its role in the global supply chain.

EU pauses tariff retaliation after Trump strikes 15% Deal

The EU had approved countermeasures to looming US tariffs, including up to 30% levies on American goods and a ban on steel, iron, and aluminium scrap exports. However, it has now paused these €93 billion measures for six months after a deal with President Trump capped most US tariffs on EU goods at 15%.